IRC: Important Notice for 10/25/26 Retreat

1 message

Yanli Wang <yanli@insightretreatcenter.org> Fri, Oct 16, 2026 at 10:54 PM
Reply-To: Yanli Wang <yanli@insightretreatcenter.org>
To: Andy McGuire <sparkyflashrebob@gmail.com>

INSIGHT RETREAT CENTER

Insight Meditation Retreat with Diana Clark, Kim Allen, David Lorey, and Ying Chen at Hidden Villa Retreat Center Los Altos Hills, CA
From October 25 to October 29, 2026 - Sunday to Thursday

Dear Andy,

This email gives important final information about your upcoming retreat:

IRC Offsite Retreat at Hidden Villa, Oct 25-29, 2026.

Please read all of it to be prepared and avoid surprises.

Timing

- Check-in is from **2:00-3:30pm** on Sunday, Oct 25th.
- **Opening circle is at 4:00pm**, and all yogis must be present. Please do not be late.
- The retreat ends before noon on Thursday, Oct 29th.

Physical Comfort and Gear

- **Bring warm clothing layers and blankets**. We are staying in a canyon that gets chilly at night this time of year. Cabins have a heater, but this is a wise precaution.
- **Bring sheets, a towel, and a pillow**. Hidden Villa does not supply these.
- **Rain** is possible during the retreat. Please pack appropriately.
- **Bring any unscented soap and shampoo** you need for showering.
- **Personal sitting gear:** We have mats, cushions, and chairs, but not extra support devices like blankets and pillows. Please bring your own if needed.
- **Headlamp / flashlight**
- **Water bottle**
- **Sturdy shoes**

Food

- **Community food provision**: The food for this retreat will be offered from the IMC community. It will be plentiful but limited to what is offered. We have taken various dietary issues into account. But if you wish to bring some personal food to supplement, you are welcome to do so.

Lodging

- **Cabins are shared** among several yogis. Cabins have heat but not running water.
- **Campers will be on platforms** in a wooded area. Please bring warm bedding!
- **Common bathrooms** are a short walk from the lodging.

Covid Protocol

- Please take a moment to read the Covid Protocol for IRC.
- Masking is optional unless someone receives a positive COVID test result or there is a significant surge in infections just before/ during the retreat. If feasible, please ensure you have N-95, KN-95, or KF-94 masks. In the event that it becomes necessary, all participants will be required to wear masks in any public areas. Anyone who wishes to do so is welcome to keep their mask on at all times.
- We recommend having the current COVID-19 vaccination.

Other General Information

- **Location**: Hidden Villa Hostel, 26870 Moody Road, Los Altos Hills, CA 94022. Follow signs to general parking, and then to the Hostel. (Parking is free during the retreat).
- **Emergency Contact # during retreats**: (650) 949-8650. Though no one may pick up, messages are checked regularly and will get through to you.
- **Your Deposit**: Your card will NOT be charged if you attend the retreat.
- **Dāna (generosity)**: At the end of the retreat there will be an opportunity to offer a donation to the teachers and to the IRC Retreat Fund. Donations may be made by credit card, cash, or check.
- **Internet and cellular-free**: In registering you agreed to refrain from the use of email, internet, or phone during the retreat. If you prefer, your phone can be kept under lock and key for the duration of the retreat.
- **Smoking**: No smoking anywhere in the facility or grounds of Hidden Villa.
- **Check the weather** here. Please be prepared.
- **Liability waiver**: Upon arrival, you'll be asked to fill out a Liability Waiver form.

We look forward to seeing you on the retreat very soon.

With Metta,

Yanli Wang
(650) 862-9653